

A+E
‘Predators to pets’
Does your feline think she’s a tiger? An exhibit at the Field Museum shows she has a point.

REAL ESTATE
Rural mashup
“Shouses” — hulking rectangular structures — combine machine shop, living space.



Nurturing next generation

As part of Muhammad Ali Day, Chicago Muslim Boxing Club shows more than just the way around the ring. **Life+Travel**

CHRIS SWEDA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE



‘People are scared’

Under the threat of mass deportations, fear, trepidation resonate for many in Chicago



Above: Audelia Alvarez Vasquez, 56, picks up her grandchildren Yulisa Martinez, 5, left, and Antonio Martinez, 9, as they head home from Columbia Explorers Academy in Chicago’s Brighton Park neighborhood at the end of the school day Thursday. **CHRIS SWEDA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Top: A man with a chain around his waist enters a plane at Gary/Chicago International Airport on Thursday after a bus dropped people off at the airport from the U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement detention facility in Broadview. **ANTONIO PEREZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

By Nell Salzman, Talia Soglin, Angie Leventis Lourgos and Laura Rodríguez Presa
Chicago Tribune

Everywhere she goes, Audelia Alvarez Vasquez has been wearing her proof of permanent residency in the United States safety-pinned to the small crocheted purse that hangs around her neck: to the grocery store, to the post office, to pick up her two grandchildren from elementary school in Brighton Park.

“I have my card here,” she said. “If (U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement) asks me, I’m ready. It’s right here. Tied up.”

Her vigilance is a testament to the fear and uncertainty that has permeated the Chicago area over the last week, as the threat of mass deportations under a second Trump administration touched so many basic aspects of daily life, from the workforce to schools to medical care to essential social services.

Although no widespread immigration raids were reported here this week, the possibility — and reports that Chicago would be ground zero for enforcement — kept many of the region’s estimated 400,000 undocumented immigrants at home.

The week of alarm and anxiety culminated on Friday when federal officials

Turn to Immigration, Page 10

A forgotten woman key to a change in forensics

Most have never heard of Marty Goddard. A new book looks at why

By Christopher Borrelli
Chicago Tribune

The first rape kits were given to hospitals in 1978. Chicago was the testing ground. According to a Tribune article from the time, more than two dozen Cook County hospitals received the kits, courtesy of the Chicago Hospital Council. Police had long insisted that corroborating evidence of sex crimes was near impossible, so Bernard Carey, then state’s attorney, explained the kits would be used to create a process for establishing evidence of a sexual assault. At the end of the article, there was a name, Louis Vitullo, a Chicago police sergeant and analyst in the crime lab who specialized in microscope work. The invention of the kit was credited to him. Vitullo had made his name a decade earlier by identifying the fingerprints of mass murderer Richard Speck.

But Vitullo didn’t invent the rape kit — at least, not alone.

Neither did Carey, whose office positioned the project as a collaboration with Vitullo.

About six years ago, journalist Pagan Kennedy — who has made inventors and the development of pioneering ideas her specialty — became obsessed with knowing who did create the first kit. She suspected the answer might not be Vitullo, partly because, in the earliest reports about the kit, another name floated in the mix of Illinois activists, politicians and police commanders involved with its development: Marty Goddard, which is what everyone called the otherwise formal Chicago woman

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INSIDE



CHRIS SWEDA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Beer and Buehrle went hand in hand

Mark Buehrle was a one-of-a-kind pitcher for the White Sox — and he enjoyed a few beers during his epic career, beginning with his first win. **Paul Sullivan in Chicago Sports**

Freight trains block crossings in Dixmoor

Suburban residents often face delays due to train tracks leading into Chicago, but in Dixmoor, the issue has become a daily frustration. **Chicagoland, Page 3**

Hegseth sworn in as Pentagon chief

The new secretary of defense joins President Donald Trump’s Cabinet after a dramatic late-night vote in the Senate where Vice President JD Vance broke a tie. **Nation & World**

Developer aiming to bypass aldermanic veto

Move would be first of its kind under 2022 change to zoning rules

By Brian J. Rogal
Chicago Tribune

Sterling Bay, the developer behind dozens of projects in Chicago, launched a last-ditch effort earlier this month to secure City Council approval for a pair of apartment towers on the western edge of Lincoln Park, attempting an end-run around an alderman opposed to the project.

The company plans to try to bypass Ald. Scott Waguespack, 32nd, and take the project directly to the City Council, marking the first time a developer will use a

2022 zoning reform that ensures some builders get an up-or-down vote if local opposition delays approval.

It’s a challenge to Chicago’s long-standing custom of “aldermanic prerogative,” which typically gives local aldermen the final word on zoning decisions in their ward. The ad hoc tradition plays a powerful — yet controversial — role in determining which developments can proceed. Supporters of aldermanic prerogative say it ensures developers can’t ignore local concerns, while opponents say the custom can squelch needed development or even help maintain historic segregation.

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Chicago Ald. Scott Waguespack, 32nd, speaks during a news conference outside City Hall on Dec. 3. **EILEEN T. MESLAR/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**